

Section B: Viva voce (Discussion)**20 marks**

17–20 marks	Detailed and informed answers, possibly illustrated with the instrument/voice, showing a full and clear awareness of expressive choices made in preparing the programme and of their effectiveness in performance.
13–16 marks	Informed answers, showing a clear awareness of expressive choices made in preparing the programme and of their effectiveness in performance.
9–12 marks	Some relevant understanding of performing choices made in the preparation of the programme and some awareness of their effect in performance.
5–8 marks	Some awareness of expressive techniques and performing choices, but not always relevant.
1–4 marks	Little relevant response to questions about expressive techniques used in the performance.

(a) Performing on a second instrument

Marks are to be given under each of the following headings, applied to the performance as a whole.

The **Level of Difficulty** should be equivalent to that of the Solo Recital in Section A.

1. Knowledge and fluency (of pitch and rhythm)

In this section, examiners assess candidates' knowledge of the music being performed. In improvisatory styles, knowledge refers to the decisions made by the candidate in terms of pitch and/or rhythm as appropriate to the instrument and style.

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates a thorough knowledge of notes and rhythms and the performance is completely fluent.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates a mainly secure knowledge of notes and rhythms; some mistakes, but not enough to disturb the basic fluency of the performance.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates a moderate knowledge of the notes and rhythm; a number of mistakes disturb the fluency of some parts of the performance.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates an erratic knowledge of the notes and rhythms; hesitancy sometimes seriously impairs the fluency of the performance.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor knowledge of notes and rhythms, showing persistent hesitancy and little fluency throughout the performance.
0 marks	The music is marred by inaccuracies and significant rhythmic hesitancy with no sense of the fluency required for a coherent performance.

2. Technical control across a range of techniques

Assessed under this heading: quality, variety and evenness of tone; the range of technical skills displayed; specific factors as they apply to the candidate's instrument/voice (e.g. co-ordination of RH/LH, bow/fingers, tongue/fingers; intonation; breath control; diction; pedalling; registration).

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates very secure technical control in every respect, across a range of advanced techniques.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates mainly secure technical control of the instrument in all significant respects, across a range of fairly advanced techniques.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates moderate technical control, with problems in some areas, across a limited range of moderately advanced techniques.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates erratic technical control, with significant problems in some areas, across a narrow range of techniques.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor technical control of the instrument, with significant problems in several areas, across a limited range of techniques.
0 marks	The candidate is not in technical control of the instrument.

3. Realisation of performance markings and/or performing conventions

Assessed under this heading: the realisation of markings written into the score by the composer and/or the observance of appropriate performing conventions (e.g. ornamentation, *notes inégales* and other Baroque rhythmical alterations, swung quavers and other jazz conventions).

9–10 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are convincingly realised throughout the performance and/or appropriate performing conventions are effectively applied.
7–8 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised throughout most of the performance and/or some appropriate performing conventions are applied.
5–6 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised in some passages in the performance and/or some appropriate performing conventions are inconsistently applied.
3–4 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are inconsistently realised in some passages in the performance and/or few performing conventions are applied.
1–2 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are seldom realised throughout most of the performance and/or performing conventions are largely ignored.
0 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are ignored throughout most of the performance and/or no performing conventions are observed.

4. Aural and stylistic understanding

Where candidates present their recitals with an accompanist, the ability to co-ordinate with the accompanist is taken into account when awarding marks in this category. In improvisatory styles, the candidates' ability to extend their part in ways appropriate to the chosen style is also considered here. Aural awareness also pertains to choices made by candidates in terms of amplification.

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates acute aural awareness and a well-developed sense of style throughout a performance which communicates a coherent understanding of the music.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates good aural awareness and a fairly well-developed sense of style, throughout a performance which communicates a mainly coherent understanding of the music.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates fairly good aural awareness and a moderate sense of style through most of a performance which communicates a general understanding of the music.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates some aural awareness and some sense of style through parts of a performance which communicates a limited understanding of the music.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates little aural awareness or sense of style throughout a performance which communicates very little understanding of the music.
0 marks	The candidate demonstrates no aural awareness, sense of style or understanding.

(b) Ensemble/duet/accompanying

(40 marks)

1. Knowledge and fluency

In this section, examiners assess candidates' knowledge of the music being performed. In improvisatory styles, knowledge refers to the decisions made by the candidate in terms of pitch and/or rhythm as appropriate to the instrument and style.

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates a thorough knowledge of notes and rhythms and the performance is completely fluent.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates a mainly secure knowledge of notes and rhythms; some mistakes, but not enough to disturb the basic fluency of the performance.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates a moderate knowledge of the notes and rhythm; a number of mistakes disturb the fluency of some parts of the performance.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates an erratic knowledge of the notes and rhythms; hesitancy sometimes seriously impairs the fluency of the performance.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor knowledge of notes and rhythms, showing persistent hesitancy and little fluency throughout the performance.

2. Technical control across a range of techniques

Assessed under this heading: quality, variety and evenness of tone; the range of technical skills displayed; specific factors as they apply to the candidate's instrument/voice (e.g. co-ordination of RH/LH, bow/fingers, tongue/fingers; intonation; breath control; diction; pedalling; registration).

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates very secure technical control in every respect, across a range of advanced techniques.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates mainly secure technical control of the instrument in all significant respects, across a range of fairly advanced techniques.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates moderate technical control with problems in some areas, across a limited range of moderately advanced techniques.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates erratic technical control, with significant problems in some areas, across a narrow range of techniques.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor technical control of the instrument, with significant problems in several areas, across a limited range of techniques.
0 marks	The candidate is not in technical control of the instrument and the range of techniques displayed is very limited.

3. Realisation of performance markings and/or performing conventions

Assessed under this heading: the realisation of markings written into the score by the composer and/or the observance of appropriate performing conventions (e.g. ornamentation, *notes inégales* and other Baroque rhythmical alterations, swung quavers and other jazz conventions).

9–10 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are convincingly realised throughout the performance and/or appropriate performing conventions are effectively applied.
7–8 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised throughout most of the performance and/or some appropriate performing conventions are applied.
5–6 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised in some passages in the performance and/or some appropriate performing conventions are inconsistently applied.
3–4 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are inconsistently realised in some passages in the performance and/or few performing conventions are applied.
1–2 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are seldom realised throughout most of the performance and/or performing conventions are largely ignored.
0 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are ignored throughout.

4. Aural and stylistic understanding

Aural awareness in relation to the ensemble and the candidate's ability to blend and co-ordinate with the other members of the ensemble is taken into account when awarding marks in this category. In improvisatory styles the candidates' ability to extend their part in ways appropriate to the chosen style is also considered here. Aural awareness also pertains to choices made by candidates in terms of amplification.

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates acute aural awareness and a well-developed sense of style, throughout a performance which communicates an alert response to the needs of the ensemble and a coherent understanding of the music.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates good aural awareness and a fairly well-developed sense of style, throughout a performance which communicates an awareness of the needs of the ensemble and a mainly coherent understanding of the music.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates fairly good aural awareness and a moderate sense of style, through most of a performance which communicates a sense of ensemble and a general understanding of the music.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates some aural awareness and some sense of style, through parts of a performance which communicates some sense of co-ordination with the rest of the group and a limited understanding of the items presented.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates little aural awareness or sense of style, throughout a performance which communicates very little awareness of the others in the ensemble or understanding of either item.
0 marks	The candidate demonstrates no aural awareness, sense of style and ensemble or understanding.

(c) Performing own composition

(40 marks)

1. Accuracy of notation and performance

A full score **must** be presented to the examiner. Improvisation is not acceptable.

9–10 marks	Wholly accurate in notation and exactly realised in performance.
7–8 marks	Almost entirely accurate in notation and mostly exact in performance.
5–6 marks	Mostly accurate in notation and fairly exact in performance.
3–4 marks	Notated accurately in some respects and partly realised accurately in performance.
1–2 marks	Only partly accurate in notation and haphazardly performed.

2. Technical and expressive understanding of the candidate's instrument or voice

9–10 marks	The composition explores a wide range of technical and expressive possibilities of the instrument/voice, showing imagination and flair, carried off wholly successfully in performance.
7–8 marks	The composition uses a wide range of technical and expressive possibilities of the instrument/voice with imagination and is presented mostly successfully in performance.
5–6 marks	The composition uses some of the technical and expressive potential of the instrument/voice and is partially successful in performance.
3–4 marks	The composition uses a limited range of technical and expressive possibilities with limited imagination, and is partly successful in performance.
1–2 marks	The composition uses few of the technical and expressive possibilities of the instrument or voice, and is carried off with little success in the performance.
0 marks	No evidence presented.

3. Technical and expressive understanding of other instruments/voices

9–10 marks	The composition explores a wide range of technical and expressive possibilities of the other instruments/voices, showing imagination and flair, which works well in performance.
7–8 marks	The composition uses a wide range of technical and expressive possibilities of the other instruments/voices with imagination, which is mostly effective in performance.
5–6 marks	The composition uses some of the technical and expressive potential of the other instruments/voices, which is partially effective in performance.
3–4 marks	The composition uses a limited range of the technical and expressive possibilities of the other instruments/voices.
1–2 marks	The composition uses few of the technical and expressive possibilities of the other instruments or voices.
0 marks	No other instruments/voices involved.

4. Aural awareness and understanding of the relationship between the candidate's instrument/voice and the other parts

9–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates keen aural awareness of the relationship between the parts, which are effectively combined.
7–8 marks	The candidate demonstrates secure aural awareness of the relationship between the parts, which are mostly effectively combined.
5–6 marks	The candidate demonstrates moderate aural awareness of the relationship between the parts, with some effective combinations.
3–4 marks	The candidate demonstrates some aural awareness of the relationship between the parts, which are only occasionally effectively combined.
1–2 marks	The candidate demonstrates little understanding of the relationship between the parts, which are rarely effectively combined.
0 marks	No other instruments/voices involved

(d) Improvising

(40 marks)

1. Fluency and form

9–10 marks	Fully fluent and very confident in delivery, with clear and convincing formal shaping.
7–8 marks	Mostly fluent and confident, with form largely evident and convincingly shaped structures.
5–6 marks	A continuous performance, perhaps relying on some repetition or with some moments of uncertainty of direction.
3–4 marks	Occasionally hesitant, not always focussed in direction/shape; the improvisation may be overlong and repetitive or too short.
1–2 marks	Little planning, often repetitive or unconvincing or often hesitant and fragmented. Extremely short.
0 marks	No evidence offered beyond the stimulus.

2. Technical control

Assessed here: quality and variety of tone; the range of technical skills displayed and control of technical areas appropriate to the candidate's instrument or voice: breathing, co-ordination, intonation, diction, pedalling, control of sound world, projection.

9–10 marks	Very secure technical control in every respect, across a range of well-developed techniques, excellently projected.
7–8 marks	Mainly secure technical control in all important respects, across a range of fairly well developed techniques.
5–6 marks	Moderate technical control with problems in some areas across a range of moderately developed techniques.
3–4 marks	Erratic technical control with some significant problems, across a narrow range of techniques.
1–2 marks	Poor technical control, with many problem areas across a very limited range of techniques.
0 marks	No evidence presented of technical skills.

3. Use of the stimulus

9–10 marks	Imaginative and adventurous use of the stimulus, with evidence of addition and extension and contrast/a creative response to the given text.
7–8 marks	Stimulus developed creatively and shaped with some contrasting material.
5–6 marks	Some attempt at melodic/rhythmic shaping and development of the stimulus.
3–4 marks	Little development of motifs, relying on repetition, or little reference to the stimulus.
1–2 marks	Stimulus ignored, little shaping of materials.
0 marks	No evidence presented.

4. Aural and stylistic understanding

Assessed here: a coherent sense of style across the improvisation; features of style appropriate (if relevant) to the improvisation (ornaments, swung rhythms, sense of space, mood; engagement with the material).

9–10 marks	Acute aural awareness and a well-developed, coherent sense of style.
7–8 marks	Good aural awareness and a fairly well-developed sense of style.
5–6 marks	Fairly good aural awareness and a moderate sense of style.
3–4 marks	Some aural and stylistic awareness.
1–2 marks	Little aural awareness or sense of style.
0 marks	No evidence of aural or stylistic understanding.

The candidate's performance in the recital as a whole is assessed and a mark given under each of the Assessment Criteria headings 1–4.

Level of Difficulty

Candidates are expected to demonstrate their skills and understanding in a performance of pieces which exhibit a level of complexity, technical challenge and musical understanding comparable to those typically found in the syllabuses of the *conservatoire* examining bodies at grade VI.

The performance of music at a level of difficulty that exceeds grade VI will access the top mark band for 'technical control' (by demonstration of *advanced techniques*) and for 'interpretative understanding' (by demonstration of *mature insight* and *acute aural awareness*).

A range of exemplar material, which shows how each of the marking criteria will take account of 'level of difficulty' across representative mark bands, is available within the Guidance for Teachers booklet (see OCR website for more detail).

1. Knowledge and fluency (of pitch and rhythm)

In this section, examiners assess candidates' knowledge of the music being performed. In improvisatory styles; knowledge refers to the decisions made by the candidate in terms of pitch and/or rhythm as appropriate to the instrument and style.

21–25 marks	The candidate demonstrates a thorough knowledge of notes and rhythms and the performance is completely fluent.
16–20 marks	The candidate demonstrates a mainly secure knowledge of notes and rhythms; some mistakes, but not enough to disturb the basic fluency of the performance.
11–15 marks	The candidate demonstrates a moderate knowledge of the notes and rhythm; a number of mistakes disturb the fluency of some parts of the performance.
6–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates an erratic knowledge of the notes and rhythms; hesitancy sometimes seriously impairs the fluency of the performance.
1–5 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor knowledge of notes and rhythms, showing persistent hesitancy and little fluency throughout the performance.
0 marks	The music is marred by inaccuracies and significant rhythmic hesitancy with no sense of the fluency required for a coherent performance.

2. Technical control

Assessed under this heading: quality, variety and evenness of tone; technical skills displayed; specific factors as they apply to the candidate's instrument/voice (e.g. co-ordination of RH/LH, bow/fingers, tongue/fingers; intonation; breath control; diction; pedalling; registration).

21–25 marks	The candidate demonstrates very secure technical control in every respect, in music that demands advanced techniques.
16–20 marks	The candidate demonstrates mainly secure technical control of the instrument or voice in all significant respects, in music that demands fairly advanced techniques.
11–15 marks	The candidate demonstrates moderate technical control, with problems in some areas, in music that demands moderately advanced techniques.
6–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates erratic technical control, with significant problems in some areas, in music that demands modest techniques.
1–5 marks	The candidate demonstrates poor technical control of the instrument or voice, with significant problems in most areas, in music that demands basic techniques.
0 marks	The candidate is not in technical control of the instrument.

3. Realisation of performance markings and/or performance conventions

Assessed under this heading: the realisation of markings written into the score by the composer and/or the observance of appropriate performing conventions (e.g. ornamentation, *notes inégales* and other Baroque rhythmic alterations, swung quavers and other conventions appropriate to jazz, popular music or other traditions).

21–25 marks	All markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are convincingly realised throughout the performance and/or all appropriate performing conventions are effectively applied.
16–20 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised throughout most of the performance and/or most appropriate performing conventions are applied.
11–15 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are realised in some passages in the performance and/or some appropriate performing conventions are inconsistently applied.
6–10 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are inconsistently realised in few passages in the performance and/or few performing conventions are applied.
1–5 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are seldom realised throughout most of the performance and/or performing conventions are largely ignored.
0 marks	Markings of tempo, expression, articulation and phrasing are ignored throughout and/or no performing conventions are applied.

4. Interpretative understanding and aural awareness

Where candidates present their recitals in an ensemble or as an accompanist, their aural awareness in relation to the ensemble and their ability to blend and co-ordinate with the other members of the ensemble, the soloist or accompanist is taken into account when awarding marks in this category. In improvisatory styles, the candidates' ability to extend their part in ways appropriate to the chosen style is also considered here. Aural awareness also pertains to choices made by candidates in terms of amplification.

21–25 marks	The candidate demonstrates mature insight, a well-developed interpretative understanding of the style of the music and acute aural awareness.
16–20 marks	The candidate demonstrates an informed interpretative understanding of the style of the music and secure aural awareness.
11–15 marks	The candidate demonstrates a secure interpretative understanding of the style of the music and mostly secure aural awareness.
6–10 marks	The candidate demonstrates a fitful interpretative understanding of the style of the music and some aural awareness.
1–5 marks	The candidate demonstrates a limited interpretative understanding of the style of the music and little aural awareness.
0 marks	The candidate demonstrates no interpretative understanding or aural awareness.

Section B: *Viva voce*

20 marks

17–20 marks	Wholly significant and appropriate listening leads to informed decisions regarding interpretative choices in the candidate's performance.
13–16 marks	Appropriate listening leads to confident decisions regarding interpretative choices in the candidate's performance.
9–12 marks	Mostly appropriate listening leads to fairly confident decisions regarding interpretative choices in the candidate's performance.
5–8 marks	Some appropriate listening informs some interpretative choices in performance.
1–4 marks	A little listening informs a few interpretative choices in performance.
0 marks	No evidence of listening informing interpretative choices in performance.

Section A: The Language of Western Tonal Harmony**45 marks****1. Harmonic Language**

Assessed under this heading: harmonic recognition in relation to the given melody, awareness of harmonic rhythm, use of range of vocabulary, connecting chords in appropriate ways at and between the 'main markers' of a phrase.

17–20 marks	Wholly appropriate use of the full range of the required harmonic language.
13–16 marks	Almost entirely appropriate use of the full range of the required harmonic language.
9–12 marks	Mainly appropriate use of most of the required range of harmonic language.
5–8 marks	Some appropriate use of a limited range of relevant harmonic language.
1–4 marks	Some use of relevant harmonic language.
0 marks	No use of relevant harmonic language.